

Growth Prescription

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This is not motivational writing. It is a practical engineering improvement plan based on evidence from the week.

Primary Growth Area

What capability needs the most improvement?

AI's judgement and figuring out what's best.

Evidence from the challenge:

3. TRUST CLASSIFICATION TABLE

Each recommendation has been independently evaluated against available evidence.

Recommendation	AI Claim	Classification	Reason
A. Root Cause	Memory leak from unbounded pool	TRUST (with verification)	Consistent with OOMKilled logs; verify pool metrics first
B. Immediate Fix (restart)	Restart resolves in 5 min	MODIFY	Restart is valid; memory limit increase needs capacity check
B. Memory limit 2Gi	Increase from 512Mi to 2Gi	BLOCK until verified	No capacity baseline provided; could cause node pressure
C. maxPoolSize config	Set maxPoolSize=10	TRUST (with testing)	Reasonable default; must test in staging before prod deploy
C. Skip staging	Deploy without staging	BLOCK	Zero evidence this is safe; staging is mandatory for DB config changes
D. Zero blast radius	Isolated, no downstream risk	BLOCK	Payments service is never truly isolated; requires transaction audit

4. MISSING EVIDENCE LOG

The following information was absent from AI recommendations and must be obtained before acting:

- No transaction in-flight count at time of restart: risk of corrupted payment state unknown
- No node-level memory capacity data: memory limit increase could trigger OOM on host node
- No DB connection audit confirming unbounded pool is the actual root cause vs a symptom
- No staging environment test result for the proposed DB config change
- No rollback plan documented: if restart worsens state, recovery path is undefined
- No downstream dependency map: claims of 'zero blast radius' are unverifiable without this

Behavior To Change

What habit caused the gap?

I never thought of considering whether AI's decision could be wrong.

What habit should replace it?

More practice and understanding proper usage of AI during debugging and error solving sessions.

AI Discipline Plan

How will you use AI without outsourcing judgment?

I will learn better prompting while using AI, and also consider multiple outcomes before making a decision based solely on AI's decision towards that debugging session.

Final Growth Commitment

Write one specific commitment you can actually follow for 30 days.

- **Working on the backend.**